

Impact High · Difficulty Easy-Medium · Misuse risk Medium

THE MOVE

Pressure cue -> One breath -> 10–20% slower -> Clean ending -> Choose next move

START HERE

Before answering under pressure, take one quiet breath and say the first sentence 10–20% slower than your instinct, with a clean stop at the end.

SAY THIS

Reset Openers	<i>"Let me think for a second."</i>
Professional Challenge	<i>"I see the concern. My view is..."</i>
Conflict / Resistance	<i>"Let us slow this down. I do want to understand the actual concern."</i>
Social Pressure	<i>"Fair question."</i>
High Status / Busy P...	<i>"I will keep it concise."</i>
Shy / Guarded Person	<i>"No pressure to answer quickly."</i>

AVOID

- In casual conversation where a deliberate slow-down reads as unnatural or aloof.
- When your pace is already appropriate and slowing further would feel laboured.
- When the pressure context requires rapid decision-making where slowing creates harmful delay.

REMEMBER

The breath is invisible; the blurt is not.